

music-dance festival

The Right Notes

MAIHAR Music festivals in small towns have their own charm. It is partly to do with the ambience and partly the audience which comprises pure rasiks who stay past midnight to early morning, not being in a hurry to head back home. They savour not just the night ragas, but the morning ones too. One such festival which has gained a name over the years is the Baba Allaudin Khan Smriti Sangeet Samaroh which is held at Maihar, Madhya Pradesh.

Baba was a great musician who not only mastered the sarod, but the shehnai and sitar as well. Apart from being a musician he was a strict teacher who mentored maestros like Pandit Ravi Shankar (sitar), Ustad Ali Akbar Khan (sarod), Annapurna Devi (surbahar), Sharan Rani (sarod), Nikhil Banerjee (sitar) and Pannalal Ghosh (flute). Being held on February 15-16, the festival will commence with performances by the Maihar Band on both days. The band has a unique

history. In 1918, after the yellow fever epidemic in Maihar, many children were orphaned. Baba inducted them into an orchestral group that later became the Maihar Band. He blended folk and western classical music and also composed for the band. The band incorporates instruments like sitar, sarod, cello, violin, nala-tarang, esraj and his own creation, the Chandra sarang.

Performances on the first day will include those by artistes such as Arunima Kumar (kuchipudi), Pandit Ajay Pohankar (vocal), Pandit Biswajit Roy Chowdhry (sarod) and a tabla jugalbandi between Gopal and Madhusudan Burman. The second day features Malavika Mitra (kathak), Runa Deh (vocal), Nishat Khan (sitar), taal vadya by Gundecha Brothers and Piu Sarkhel (vocal). Sarkhel is one of the few female vocalists representing the Indore gharana. A talent to watch out for. Also, don't miss the brilliance of Nishat Khan's sitar from the Imdad gharana. Come soak in some soulful music.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

INSTRUMENTAL: Biswajit Roy Chowdhry (left); Pohankar



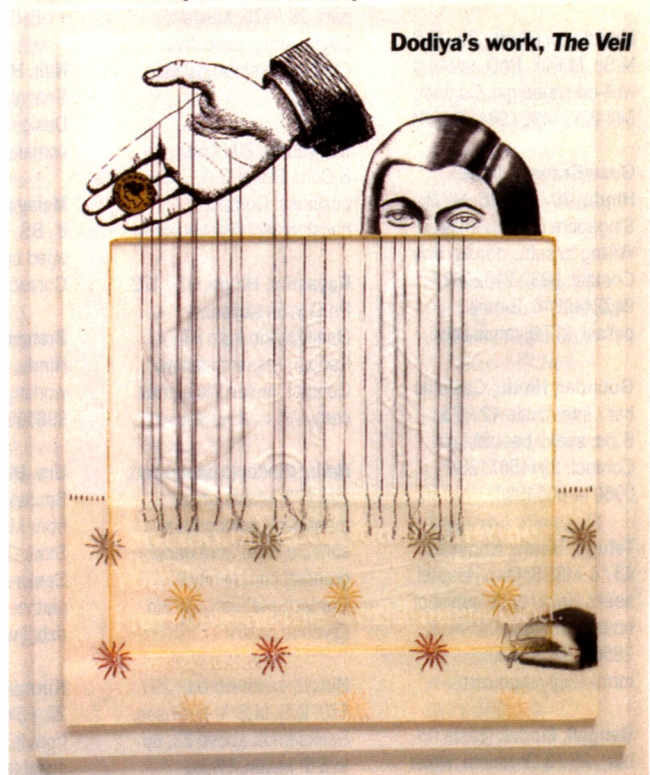
YASBANT NEGI

art exhibition

Sacred Feminine

MUMBAI With every brush stroke she has refined her talent. Anju Dodiya's artwork unfolds a textured, thoughtful story, which reflects an intuitively feminine orientation. The use of brilliant colours and the numerous symbolic layers woven into each painting give a sense of the stark simplicity within her. Adherence to the essential and the feminine is clearly visible in the embroidered textiles, floral forms and mythic references she uses. The latest collection, All Night I Shall Gallop, showcases 40 new pieces. These works, a product of her residency at the Singapore Tyler Print Institute, deal with paper pulp and print. At Tao Art Gallery from February 15 to 29. by Swati Mathur

Dodiya's work, *The Veil*



art

Wild Creations

DELHI Artist Shuvasprasad's recent works reflect the turmoil in Nandigram. On display, from February 15 to March 1, his work captures the killing fields and predator-like figures of the

hawks and owls as they seek their prey. Known for his penchant for pastoral and romantic subjects, he has witnessed the acts and expressed them through

his work. The exhibition features mixed media, charcoals and sculptures. The images impress because of their sheer vitality and power. At Art Alive Gallery.



The Bronze Bird